

Respect Yourself and Others: It Starts with You, Featuring Doug Buce

Doug Buce, President, CLO, Boing Dynamics, Inc.

There are three dimensions of energy you need to foster to be a healthy teammate. And when you intentionally foster these areas, respect for yourself will grow.

The most obvious dimension is physical. Here are some tips to foster this dimension.

Get up and move. Have stand-up meetings. Take a break every hour or so to walk around your floor. If you have a gym at work or nearby, use it. Stay committed to your own personal wellness and well-being. A healthy you is a productive you.

Eat better. Don't skip meals. Eat healthy snacks like fruit, nuts, and yogurt. Stay hydrated, because even mild dehydration zaps cognitive ability.

Get more sleep. Go to bed an hour earlier, and turn off all technology an hour earlier before you get into bed, to clear your mind.

The next dimension is mental. You can increase your mental activity in the following ways.

Quit multitasking. It drains mental energy and actually reduces efficiency by up to 40 percent. Although Pat was a master multitasker, it does take a mental toll and lowers overall productivity. Leverage your mornings for success throughout the day. You are more focused in the morning. By the way, 10:26 a.m. is the most focused minute of your day.

Use your vacation days or personal time off. Oh, and leave your computer at home. Use this time to rest and reenergize. You will come back a stronger, more focused leader with new ideas and inspiration.

And turn off your smartphone notifications. Digital distractions are driving our society to a counter-productive state.

Dedicate specific times of the day to respond to email and other communications.

The third dimension is emotion.

Most of us feel best when we're positive, so, at the beginning of each week, write down a list of things you're thankful for. Share this list with others as appropriate and reflect on all the good things in your life.

Laugh a little. Pat believed in the power of laughter and was able to laugh at herself. When Pat was 29 years old, she got braces and one night she and (assistant coach) Mickie DeMoss were scouting at a high school game, and while watching the game, Pat and Mickie chatted and ate popcorn.

Finally, Mickie said, 'You know, you have popcorn stuck in your braces.' Mickie razzed her about it until she started giggling. Pat laughed at herself and said, 'It was a good feeling, too.' That's when you know you have a real self-respect.

And finally, tell others how much you appreciate them. They will feel more bonded to you, and it makes you feel good.

There you have it. Physical, mental, and emotional dimensions that you should focus on to create a healthier you worthy of respect. Pat embodied these dimensions and it showed in both her life and in her leadership.

Are you respecting yourself enough so that others, in turn, will respect you?